Restaurant Guide for CSFAI Attendees

Santa Barbara and Goleta

Welcome to Santa Barbara. These suggestions cover seafood, Italian, Asian fusion, Mexican, Spanish, Mediterranean, and casual American dining for meals outside the conference program. Choose Goleta for convenience near UCSB, or Santa Barbara for downtown and waterfront dining.

Goleta and near UCSB

The Ellwood at Goleta Beach

Type: Coastal California and seafood. For an oceanfront meal at Goleta Beach, close to UCSB. A scenic choice for lunch, dinner, or weekend brunch.

5905 Sandspit Road, Goleta | theellwood.com

Marisella at The Ritz Carlton Bacara

Type: Coastal Italian and upscale dining. For a special-occasion dinner of handmade pasta, local seafood, and wood-fired dishes with ocean views.

8301 Hollister Avenue, Santa Barbara | marisellarestaurant.com

Lulio at The Ritz Carlton Bacara

Type: Mediterranean and upscale resort dining. For Mediterranean-inspired cuisine, seasonal ingredients, and panoramic ocean views in an elegant resort setting.

8301 Hollister Avenue, Santa Barbara | Ritz-Carlton Bacara dining

Ca'Dario Goleta

Type: Italian. For pasta, pizza, and traditional Italian dishes without going downtown. The restaurant has an outdoor dining area.

250 Storke Road, Goleta | cadariorestaurants.com/goleta

Jane at the Marketplace

Type: California bistro and American. For a sit-down meal with a broad menu and a dedicated vegetarian menu. Convenient for visitors staying in Goleta.

6940 Marketplace Drive, Goleta | janeatthemarketplace.com

Los Agaves Goleta

Type: Mexican. For a casual Mexican meal in the Camino Real Marketplace. A convenient option for an informal dinner with colleagues.

7024 Marketplace Drive, Goleta | los-agaves.com/locations

Before you go. Check current hours and menus on the linked websites. Reserve ahead for weekend dinners where reservations are offered, especially for groups. Bring a layer for outdoor seating.

Santa Barbara restaurants

Aegean Neotaverna

Type: Contemporary Mediterranean. For an updated take on Mediterranean classics in De La Guerra Plaza. A good choice for exploring Aegean flavors downtown.

731 De La Guerra Plaza, Santa Barbara | aegeansb.com

Barbareño

Type: Contemporary California and regional Santa Barbara cuisine. For creative interpretations of Central Coast flavors and local culinary traditions. A good choice for diners interested in regional cooking.

205 West Canon Perdido Street, Santa Barbara | barbareno.com

Lure Fish House

Type: Seafood and oyster bar. For fish, shellfish, and oysters in the upper State Street area. A useful alternative to driving all the way downtown.

3815 State Street, Suite G131, Santa Barbara | lurefishhouse.com

Secret Bao

Type: Asian fusion. For creative bao buns, noodle dishes, and dumplings. A good choice for a small group interested in trying several dishes.

1201 Anacapa Street, Santa Barbara | secretbaosb.com

Sama Sama Kitchen

Type: Southeast Asian fusion. For Southeast Asian inspired dishes featuring local produce. A good choice for sharing dishes over dinner downtown.

1208 State Street, Santa Barbara | samasamakitchen.com

Jane Santa Barbara

Type: California bistro and American. For seafood, pasta, salads, and other bistro dishes in the downtown theater district. A separate location from Jane in Goleta.

1311 State Street, Santa Barbara | janesb.com

Loquita

Type: Spanish. For tapas, paella, and a dinner built around sharing plates. Located on lower State Street near the Funk Zone.

202 State Street, Santa Barbara | loquitasb.com

Santo Mezcal

Type: Modern Mexican and seafood. For contemporary Mexican cooking, seafood dishes, and cocktails. A convenient choice when exploring lower State Street.

119 State Street, Santa Barbara | santomezcalsb.com

More Italian restaurants in Santa Barbara

Manifattura

Type: Italian. For regional Italian cooking and handmade pasta on lower State Street. A newer option for an Italian dinner downtown.

413 State Street, Santa Barbara | manifatturasb.com

Toma Restaurant and Bar

Type: Italian inspired Mediterranean. For an Italian inspired dinner on the Santa Barbara waterfront. Particularly suitable for a small group or a special evening.

324 West Cabrillo Boulevard, Santa Barbara | tomarestaurant.com

Olio e Limone Ristorante

Type: Italian. For a traditional Italian dinner near downtown State Street. Choose Olio Pizzeria next door if you specifically want pizza.

11 West Victoria Street, Suite 17, Santa Barbara | olioelimone.com

Via Maestra 42

Type: Italian trattoria and deli. For Italian pasta, panini, and classic dishes on upper State Street. Its menus also include vegetarian and vegan choices.

3343 State Street, Santa Barbara | viamaestra42.com

Convivo Restaurant and Bar

Type: Italian fusion. For creative Italian cooking with global influences, including pasta and wood-fired pizza. Located at the Santa Barbara Inn across from East Beach.

901 East Cabrillo Boulevard, Santa Barbara | convivorestaurant.com

Planning a group dinner

Lure Fish House. Parties under eight are seated in order of arrival. Call the Santa Barbara restaurant at 805 618 1816 for reservations for eight or more.

Toma. The restaurant does not accommodate parties of nine or more. Choose another venue for a larger gathering.

Loquita. The restaurant provides a reservation process for groups of nine to nineteen. Contact it directly or follow its website instructions.

Dietary preferences. Jane at the Marketplace has a vegetarian menu. Via Maestra 42 and Convivo list vegetarian and vegan choices. Confirm specific needs with the restaurant.

Restaurant details checked October 2026 using official restaurant websites. Menus, hours, and reservation policies may change. Website links accompany each listing.